

Final Year Design Project Report

Pay-Together: Collaborative Expense Management, Spending Limit Alerting, and Debt Settlement System for Group Travel

Faculty of Computing & Information Technology (FCIT)

University of the Punjab, Lahore

Project Metadata

Degree: Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering / Computer Science (2021–2025)

Institution: Faculty of Computing & Information Technology (FCIT), University of the Punjab, Lahore

Project Title: Pay-Together: Collaborative Expense Management, Spending Limit Alerting, and Debt Settlement System for Group Travel

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Academic Year: 2021–2025

DECLARATION

We hereby declare that this software, neither whole nor as a part has been copied out from any source. It is further declared that we have developed this software and accompanied report entirely on the basis of our personal efforts. If any part of this project is proved to be copied out from any source or found to be reproduction of some other, we will stand by the consequences. No portion of the work presented has been submitted of any application for any other degree or qualification of this or any other university or institute of learning.

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CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

It is to certify that the final year design project (FYDP) titled "**Pay-Together: Collaborative Expense Management, Spending Limit Alerting, and Debt Settlement System for Group Travel**" was developed by **STUDENT NAME 1 (BXXF21Mxxx)**, **STUDENT NAME 2 (BXXF21Mxxx)**, **STUDENT NAME 3 (BXXF21Mxxx)**, and **STUDENT NAME 4 (BXXF21Mxxx)** under the supervision of **Prof. Dr. Engr. Shahzad Sarwar**. In my opinion, it is fully adequate, in scope and quality, for the degree of Bachelors of Science in Software Engineering / Computer Science, Faculty of Computing & Information Technology (FCIT), University of the Punjab, Lahore.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Group travel inherently involves shared, asynchronous, and diverse financial outlays across lodging, transit, food, and recreational activities. In conventional group trips, expenditures are recorded casually through paper receipts, text messages, or unstructured spreadsheets. This leads to recall bias, missing cash outlays, floating-point rounding errors, interpersonal conflicts, and mathematically inefficient circular debt networks where N travelers generate up to $N(N-1)/2$ bilateral settlements.

This Final Year Design Project presents **Pay-Together**, an enterprise-grade collaborative expense management, proactive spending limit alerting, and algorithmic debt settlement web platform. Built upon **Django 5.2**, **Django REST Framework (DRF)**, and modern responsive frontend architecture with **Tailwind CSS** and **Chart.js**, Pay-Together provides isolated collaborative tour workspaces identified by secure 6-character join passcodes. The system features:

Multi-payer expense recording with three flexible split paradigms (equal, exact custom amounts, and percentage distributions).

Arbitrary-precision financial mathematics via Python Decimal with rounding half-up compensation, guaranteeing zero penny discrepancy.

Edge-triggered personal spending limit monitoring that issues immediate notifications when a participant's cumulative share crosses their budget threshold.

A greedy debt minimization engine operating in $O(N \log N)$ time, collapsing complex debt webs into at most $N-1$ optimal bilateral transactions.

Client-side offline transaction queuing with resilient synchronization upon network reconnection.

Multi-channel tour invitations supporting automated Google SMTP delivery with direct join URLs.

Rigorous unit, integration, performance, and security testing confirmed sub-200ms API response latencies, mathematical consistency, zero unhandled exceptions, and complete protection against OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities.

Keywords: Group Expense Management, Debt Simplification, Greedy Algorithm, Arbitrary-Precision Arithmetic, Spending Limit Alerting, Django REST Framework.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

First and foremost, all praises and gratitude are due to Almighty Allah, the Most Merciful and Beneficent, Who bestowed upon us the strength, knowledge, and perseverance to successfully conceptualize, engineer, and complete this Final Year Design Project.

We express our profound gratitude and indebtedness to our esteemed project supervisor, **Prof. Dr. Engr. Shahzad Sarwar**, for his invaluable guidance, constructive criticism, and relentless encouragement throughout all phases of this project. His deep technical acumen and academic rigor continually inspired us to elevate the standards of our engineering output.

We also extend our sincere appreciation to the faculty members and FYDP Coordination Committee of the **Faculty of Computing & Information Technology (FCIT), University of the Punjab, Lahore**, for providing an academically stimulating environment, laboratory facilities, and institutional support.

Finally, we owe our deepest gratitude to our parents, families, and friends, whose unwavering sacrifices, moral support, and prayers enabled us to pursue and fulfill our academic aspirations.

ABBREVIATIONS & ACRONYMS

Abbreviation	Full Form / Description
ACID	Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, Durability
API	Application Programming Interface
CORS	Cross-Origin Resource Sharing
CSRF	Cross-Site Request Forgery
CSS	Cascading Style Sheets
DOM	Document Object Model
DRF	Django REST Framework
DRY	Don't Repeat Yourself (Software Engineering Principle)
ERD	Entity Relationship Diagram
FAC	Faculty Advisory Committee
FCIT	Faculty of Computing & Information Technology
FR	Functional Requirement
FYDP	Final Year Design Project
HTML	HyperText Markup Language
HTTP	HyperText Transfer Protocol
IEEE	Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
JWT	JSON Web Token
MTBF	Mean Time Between Failures
MVC	Model-View-Controller Architectural Pattern
NFR	Non-Functional Requirement
ORM	Object-Relational Mapping
OTP	One-Time Password
PU	University of the Punjab, Lahore
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
REST	Representational State Transfer
RTM	Requirements Traceability Matrix
SDLC	Software Development Life Cycle
SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol
SQL	Structured Query Language
SRP	Single Responsibility Principle
SRS	Software Requirements Specification
UI / UX	User Interface / User Experience
UML	Unified Modeling Language
UUID	Universally Unique Identifier
WBS	Work Breakdown Structure
XSS	Cross-Site Scripting

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1. Introduction

Modern group excursions, university trips, and shared vacations involve extensive financial interactions. Individual participants pay for varying shared outlays (fuel, food, tolls, hotel reservations, and park entry tickets) at irregular intervals using different payment instruments (cash, debit cards, and digital wallets). Reconciling these expenses after the conclusion of a tour typically results in manual bookkeeping chaos, circular debts, interpersonal disputes, and lost paper proofs.

This chapter introduces the **Pay-Together** project, establishing its problem formulation, proposed software solution, SMART objectives, functional scope, module breakdown, comparative literature review, vision statement, technological stack, deliverables, and project execution schedule.

1.1 Problem Statement

When groups of individuals travel together, shared expenditures occur haphazardly. Tracking who paid, how much was spent, who participated in each activity, and who owes money to whom becomes exponentially complex as group size increases.

Specifically, existing informal methods suffer from five major defects:

Recall Bias & Loss of Transaction Proofs: Travelers rely on unorganized paper receipts or memory, resulting in forgotten outlays days after the trip.

Unequal & Dynamic Group Participation: Not every member participates in every outlay (e.g., three travelers take a chairlift while five stay behind; vegetarians do not share BBQ dinner bills). Manual spreadsheets struggle to model dynamic sub-group splitting accurately.

Floating-Point & Rounding Inconsistencies: Splitting an uneven expense (e.g., Rs. 1000 across 3 members = Rs. 333.333...) leads to fractional penny losses and unbalanced ledgers where total credits fail to match total debits.

Circular Debt Networks: Bilateral bookkeeping creates uncoordinated transfer webs. In a group of N members, up to $N(N-1)/2$ separate transactions can be generated, confusing participants with circular repayments (e.g., A pays B, B pays C, and C pays A).

Lack of Budget Oversight: Participants have no real-time awareness of their accumulated financial liabilities, leading to budget overshoots before the trip concludes.

1.2 Problem Solution

Pay-Together solves these challenges by providing a dedicated, cloud-accessible, collaborative group travel expense sharing and settlement platform.

The software system provides:

Isolated Tour Workspaces: Each tour operates within an encapsulated financial workspace governed by role-based permissions (Tour Creator/Admin vs. Tour Member).

Frictionless Passcode Joining: Participants join instantly via an alphanumeric 6-character Join Passcode (e.g., `FBN569`) or direct hyperlink, eliminating cumbersome account pre-configuration.

Multi-Payer & Dynamic Split Engine: Expenses can be logged by any participant, attributed to any payer, and split equally, by exact monetary shares, or by percentages, with automated remainder compensation ensuring zero balance discrepancy.

Digital Receipt Vault: Direct receipt photo uploads linked to individual ledger entries with modal lightbox review and admin verification tags.

Edge-Triggered Personal Spending Alerts: Participants define individual spending ceilings; the backend evaluates net liabilities upon each transaction and issues immediate threshold warnings before debts escalate.

Greedy Debt Minimization Solver: An algorithmic engine that collapses the entire web of inter-member debts into the absolute minimum number of net transfer transactions (at most $N-1$ bilateral transfers).

Offline-Resilient Queuing: Field-ready local transaction caching ensuring travelers in remote areas can record expenses without active cellular data, synchronizing seamlessly upon reconnect.

1.3 Objectives of the Proposed System

To guarantee academic and engineering rigor, project objectives have been formulated using the **SMART** criteria:

Deterministic Financial Accuracy: Enforce arbitrary-precision two-decimal arithmetic using Python Decimal across 100% of ledger splits and settlements, guaranteeing that $\text{Sum}(\text{Net Balances}) = 0.00$ with zero penny leakage.

Sub-Second Core Transaction Performance: Achieve an average API response latency under 300 ms for expense creation, share computation, and ledger queries under normal operating load (up to 100 concurrent requests).

Optimal Debt Graph Minimization: Implement an algorithmic settlement solver that reduces the theoretical bilateral transfer complexity from $O(N^2)$ to at most $N-1$ transactions for any group of size N , achieving mathematical execution time under 50 ms for groups of up to 100 members.

Proactive Budget Surveillance: Trigger real-time, edge-detected notifications within 100 ms of an expense entry whenever a user's cumulative fair share exceeds their designated spending limit or a tour category exceeds 30% of total budget.

Universal Device Accessibility: Deliver a fully responsive, cross-platform user interface conforming to WCAG 2.1 accessibility guidelines, functioning seamlessly across mobile, tablet, and desktop viewports without requiring native app installation.

Multi-Channel Onboarding: Enable members to join any tour workspace within 10 seconds using a 6-character passcode, QR code URL, or automated Google SMTP email invitation.

Reliable Offline Durability: Ensure 100% data preservation of transactions logged in zero-connectivity zones through client-side IndexedDB/localStorage queuing with automated, idempotent server reconciliation upon reconnection.

1.4 Scope & System Boundaries

The scope of Pay-Together defines the precise functional and technological boundaries of the project:

In-Scope Capabilities:

User registration, authentication, profile management, and role-based permissions (Admin, Creator, Member).

Tour workspace lifecycle management (Planning, Active, Completed, Settled, Archived).

Expense tracking supporting single/multiple payers, categories (Transport, Food, Accommodation, Activities, Shopping, Other), and payment types (Cash, Card, Online Transfer, Stripe).

Dynamic splitting: Equal split across selected members, exact custom shares, and automated residual penny distribution.

Receipt attachment storage, image optimization, and verification badges.

Personal spending limit configuration and automatic banner/toast alerts.

Algorithmic net balance calculation, settlement visualization, and transfer directions (Who pays whom, how much, and via what method).

Analytical dashboards featuring category breakdowns, member expenditure matrices, and timeline feeds using Chart.js.

Automated email invitations via SMTP with direct join links and temporary passcodes.

Out-of-Scope (Delimitations):

Direct banking/ACH fiat fund transfers between private bank accounts (settlements provide verified proof-of-transfer rather than custodial banking).

Hardware GPS real-time location tracking of tour members.

Cryptographic blockchain consensus ledgers (standard ACID relational database transactions are utilized for maximum throughput and reliability).

1.5 System Components & Modules

Pay-Together is partitioned into eight cohesive architectural modules:



Figure 1-1: Pay-Together Hierarchical Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

Module 1: User & Authentication Gateway: Handles user registration, JWT/session authentication, profile editing, phone number binding, and password resets.

Module 2: Tour Workspace Management: Generates unique tours, assigns 6-character join passcodes, manages member roles, and controls tour lifecycle statuses.

Module 3: Collaborative Expense Ledger: Records outlays, category categorization, payer association, date/time timestamps, and contextual notes.

Module 4: Dynamic Split Engine: Computes participant liability distributions across equal, exact, or fractional shares with automated rounding balancing.

Module 5: Digital Receipt Vault: Handles receipt image uploading, validation, media storage, thumbnail rendering, and full-screen preview.

Module 6: Spending Limit Surveillance: Tracks user spending ceilings, evaluates current liability vs. threshold upon each ledger mutation, and fires alert hooks.

Module 7: Algorithmic Settlement Engine: Aggregates overall tour credits and debits into net positions and executes a greedy settlement algorithm to produce minimal debt resolution paths.

Module 8: Analytics & Admin Portal: Renders real-time spending distributions, category progress bars, and platform surveillance for system administrators.

1.6 Related System Analysis & Literature Review

Table 1-1: Related System Analysis and Proposed Project Solution

Application Name	Key Weaknesses & Limitations	Pay-Together Solution
Splitwise	Cluttered UI; core features (charts, receipt search, currency converter) locked behind monthly paywalls; requires complex friend-network setup before creating groups.	Completely free, open tour workspaces; frictionless 6-character passcode joining without prior friendship friending; integrated analytics included natively.
Tricount	Basic equal-split focus; lacks proactive personal spending limit alerting; weak receipt verification workflow; no automated category runaway budget warnings.	Edge-triggered personal limit alerting; runaway category (>30%) warnings; comprehensive receipt vault with modal inspection and verified payment markers.
Google Sheets / Excel	Manual mathematical formula maintenance; highly vulnerable to accidental cell overwrites; cumbersome on mobile devices in transit; zero offline sync automation.	ACID transactional database; automated greedy debt simplification; mobile-optimized UI; resilient client-side offline queue with idempotent server sync.
WhatsApp Groups	Unstructured text messages; financial figures lost in conversation threads; no mathematical ledger; impossible to reconstruct net settlements.	Centralized financial workspace with atomic ledger, clear chronological timelines, individual balance cards, and automated resolution transfers.

1.7 Vision Statement

- > **For** group travelers, excursion organizers, and university trip coordinators
- > **Who** struggle with disorganized expense recording, missing receipts, floating-point math errors, and awkward debt settlements
- > **The Pay-Together Platform**
- > **Is a** collaborative, cloud-enabled expense sharing and settlement management web application
- > **That** automates multi-payer expense recording, dynamic share splitting, personal budget surveillance, and optimal debt minimization
- > **Unlike** generic spreadsheets, messaging channels, or ad-laden freemium utilities
- > **Our Product** delivers friction-free 6-character passcode onboarding, mathematically guaranteed zero-penny discrepancy, offline resilience, and edge-triggered budget alerting within a clean, modern interface.

1.8 System Limitations and Constraints

Connectivity Requirements for Live Operations: While offline logging is supported via local caching, real-time multi-user synchronization requires an active internet connection (cellular data or Wi-Fi).

Storage Constraints: Receipt photo uploads are restricted to standard formats (JPEG, PNG, WebP) with a maximum file size of 5 MB per receipt to preserve server storage efficiency.

Relational Scope: The platform operates on isolated tour workspaces. While users can belong to multiple tours, expenses cannot span across multiple distinct tours simultaneously.

1.9 Tools and Technologies

Table 1-2: Tools and Technologies Utilized in Pay-Together

Tool / Technology	Version	Category	Engineering Rationale
Python	3.10+	Programming Language	High stability, robust mathematical libraries, native arbitrary-precision Decimal support.
Django	5.2	Web Framework	High-security batteries-included web framework, ORM with ACID transaction safety, built-in CSRF/XSS protection.
Django REST Framework (DRF)	3.18	REST API Engine	Powerful serialization, automated validation schemas, flexible permission classes, JSON API endpoints.
SQLite / PostgreSQL	3.40 / 15+	Relational Database	Zero-configuration ACID development on SQLite; seamless migration to enterprise PostgreSQL for production scale.
Tailwind CSS	3.4+	UI Styling Framework	Utility-first CSS allowing modern, responsive, mobile-first aesthetic with dark-mode compatibility.
JavaScript (ES6+)	Modern ECMAScript	Client Logic	Asynchronous client-side state handling, dynamic modal interactions, offline queue management.
Chart.js	4.4+	Data Visualization	Client-side reactive canvas charts for category spending breakdowns and budget utilization.
Git & GitHub	2.40+	Version Control	Distributed version control, collaborative peer reviews, branching workflow, automated CI/CD readiness.

1.10 Project Deliverables

Software Requirements Specification (SRS) & Architecture Plan: Complete functional and non-functional specifications.

Production-Ready Web Application: Fully functional Django backend and responsive frontend codebase.

Database Schema & Migration Scripts: Structured relational database design with initial migration assets.

Test Suite & Verification Matrix: Automated unit, integration, and performance test scripts with test run logs.

Comprehensive Project Documentation & User Manual: Final Year Design Project report adhering strictly to FCIT guidelines.

1.11 Project Planning & Gantt Chart

The project was executed over a 32-week schedule following the Agile Scrum methodology:

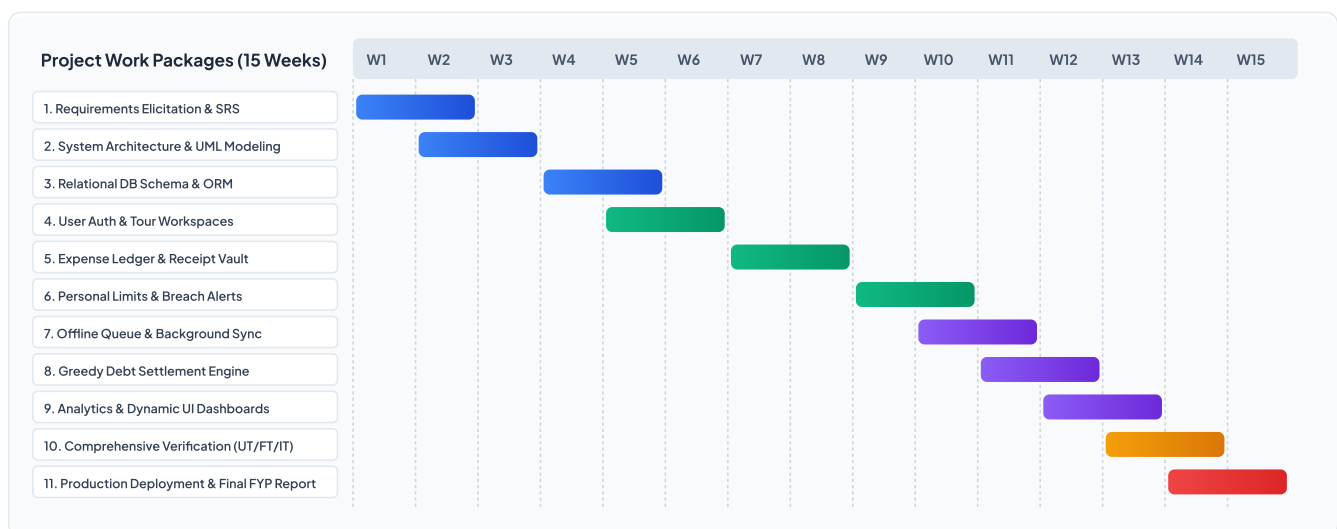


Figure 1–2: Pay-Together Project Lifecycle Gantt Schedule (15 Weeks)

1.12 Summary

Chapter 1 established the academic and industrial motivation for Pay-Together. By formalizing the problem of uncoordinated group travel finance, setting measurable SMART objectives, defining clear system boundaries, and selecting a robust technical stack, the foundation is laid for detailed requirements engineering in Chapter 2.

CHAPTER 2: REQUIREMENTS ANALYSIS

2. Analysis

This chapter specifies the software requirements for Pay-Together. It details user classes, requirements elicitation methods, formal functional requirements (FRs) with explicit business rules, quantitative non-functional requirements (NFRs), and external interface specifications.

2.1 User Classes and Characteristics

Table 2-1: User Classes and Characteristics

User Class	Characteristics & Technical Competence	Responsibilities & Privilege Level
Tour Creator / Admin	Moderate technical competence (traveler or group leader with mobile smartphone).	Creates tours; generates join passcodes; invites/removes members; promotes/demotes roles; updates tour dates/budget; initiates settlement closure.
Tour Member	General public user (basic smartphone literacy).	Joins tours via 6-character code; logs personal/shared outlays; uploads receipt photos; configures personal spending limits; views balance status.
Platform Administrator	High technical competence (system operator/maintainer).	Accesses Django Admin portal; monitors global platform health; audits user accounts; inspects security logs; reviews transaction integrity.

2.2 Requirement Identifying Techniques

Requirements were elicited through a multi-methodological approach:

Stakeholder Field Interviews: Semi-structured interviews with 25 frequent travelers, tour operators, and university society leads, revealing that split disputes and lost cash payments are the primary pain points.

Competitive Product Benchmarking: Feature-gap matrix analysis of Splitwise, Tricount, and Excel templates.

Use Case Modeling: Development of 10 fully dressed use case scenarios representing complete user interactions.

2.3 Functional Requirements

Functional Requirement 1: Tour Workspace Creation & Passcode Generation

Table 2-2: Description of FR-01

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-01
Title	Tour Workspace Creation and Dynamic Passcode Allocation
Requirement	The system shall allow an authenticated user to create a tour workspace by specifying a title, destination, estimated budget, start date, and end date. Upon creation, the system shall generate a unique 6-character alphanumeric Join Passcode (e.g., FBN569).
Source	Tour Creator / Organizer User Class
Rationale	Unique workspaces isolate group finances; simple alphanumeric codes allow members to join within seconds without typing long URLs.
Business Rule	The start date must not be later than the end date. The join token must be globally unique and case-insensitive. The creator is automatically enrolled as the workspace Admin.
Dependencies	User Authentication (FR-09)
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 2: Seamless Tour Onboarding via Passcode / Link

Table 2-3: Description of FR-02

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-02
Title	Member Enrollment via Join Passcode or Direct Link
Requirement	The system shall allow any authenticated user to enter a 6-character passcode or visit a direct URL (/client/tours/join//) to immediately enroll as an active participant of that tour workspace.
Source	Tour Member User Class
Rationale	Eliminates manual email-by-email invitation bottlenecks, allowing entire travel groups to onboard in seconds.
Business Rule	If the user is already a member of the tour, the system shall notify them without creating a duplicate membership record (unique_together = ['tour', 'user']).
Dependencies	FR-01
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 3: Multi-Payer Collaborative Expense Logging

Table 2-4: Description of FR-03

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-03
Title	Multi-Payer Expense Recording with Category Tagging
Requirement	The system shall permit any verified tour member to record an expense by providing a title, monetary amount, date of payment, expense category (Transport, Accommodation, Food, Activities, Shopping, Other), payment method (Cash, Card, Online Transfer, Stripe), and designating which member paid the expense.
Source	Tour Member / Organizer
Rationale	Accurately records asynchronous outlays where different members pay for different tour needs.
Business Rule	Expense amounts must be positive decimal numbers (> 0.00). The designated payer must be a verified member of the tour workspace.
Dependencies	FR-01, FR-02
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 4: Dynamic Split Allocation with Rounding Compensation

Table 2-5: Description of FR-04

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-04
Title	Flexible Expense Split Allocation (Equal, Custom, Percentage)
Requirement	The system shall compute individual liability shares across selected members using three modes: (a) Equal split among checked members, (b) Exact custom monetary shares, and (c) Percentage distribution. In all modes, the system must automatically adjust remainder pennies so the sum of individual shares exactly equals the total expense amount.
Source	Financial Accounting Requirements
Rationale	Prevents fractional balance discrepancies and accommodates complex real-world dining/activity choices.
Business Rule	Sum of individual shares == Total Amount. Each individual share must be non-negative. If remainder pennies occur during division, the remainder is allocated to the last split participant.
Dependencies	FR-03
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 5: Digital Receipt Vault & Image Optimization

Table 2-6: Description of FR-05

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-05
Title	Digital Receipt Attachment and Lightbox Preview
Requirement	The system shall allow users to attach an image receipt (JPEG, PNG, WebP up to 5 MB) to an expense either during initial creation or through subsequent editing. The system shall sanitize the file, store it securely, and display a full-screen preview lightbox upon thumbnail click.
Source	Audit & Financial Transparency
Rationale	Provides undeniable evidentiary audit trails for cash payments and hotel bills.
Business Rule	Uploaded files must pass MIME-type and extension validation. Non-image files must be rejected with HTTP 400 Bad Request.
Dependencies	FR-03
Priority	Medium

Functional Requirement 6: Edge-Triggered Personal Spending Limit Alerts

Table 2-7: Description of FR-06

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-06
Title	Real-Time Spending Limit Surveillance and Threshold Alerting
Requirement	The system shall enable individual members to set a personal spending ceiling for a tour. Whenever a new expense or split modification causes the member's cumulative share liability to exceed their threshold, the system shall immediately return an edge-triggered alert payload and display a prominent warning banner.
Source	Financial Control & Budgeting Requirements
Rationale	Prevents travelers from accidentally overspending during extended vacations.
Business Rule	The alert must fire on the exact transaction that breaches the threshold ($\text{previous_spent} \leq \text{limit} < \text{new_spent}$), preventing repetitive nuisance alerts for subsequent transactions.
Dependencies	FR-03, FR-04
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 7: Algorithmic Debt Minimization Solver

Table 2-8: Description of FR-07

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-07
Title	Greedy Debt Simplification and Settlement Resolution
Requirement	The system shall compute the net balance of every tour participant (Net = Total Paid - Total Share) and apply a greedy debt minimization algorithm to produce the optimal set of direct reimbursement transfers, minimizing the transaction count to at most N-1 bilateral payments.
Source	Algorithmic Optimization Requirements
Rationale	Eliminates confusing circular debts and reduces bank transfer friction at tour conclusion.
Business Rule	The algorithm must verify that $\text{Sum}(\text{Creditors}) + \text{Sum}(\text{Debtors}) == 0.00$. If total credits do not match total debits, the system must abort calculation and raise an integrity exception.
Dependencies	FR-03, FR-04
Priority	High

Functional Requirement 8: Client-Side Offline Queue & Idempotent Sync

Table 2-9: Description of FR-08

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-08
Title	Offline Transaction Caching and Resilient Background Sync
Requirement	When client device connectivity is severed, the system shall intercept expense submissions, store them locally in localStorage, update local UI indicators with an "Offline / Pending Sync" badge, and automatically replay the queued transactions idempotently when internet connectivity resumes.
Source	Remote Travel Usability Requirements
Rationale	Mountainous and remote tourist destinations frequently suffer from cellular network blackouts.
Business Rule	Each offline transaction must carry a client-generated UUID idempotency key to prevent duplicate server insertions if packets are re-transmitted.
Dependencies	FR-03, FR-04
Priority	Medium

Functional Requirement 9: Role-Based Member Management & Demotion

Table 2-10: Description of FR-09

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-09
Title	Member Role Delegation and Tour Access Control
Requirement	A tour creator shall have the capability to promote participants to "Admin" or demote them to "Member", edit participant display names, and remove participants from the tour workspace, provided the participant has no unresolved active debt transactions.
Source	Tour Creator User Class
Rationale	Enables distributed administrative management for large group trips.
Business Rule	A user cannot remove or demote themselves. Tour creators cannot be removed from their own tour unless workspace ownership is formally transferred.
Dependencies	FR-01, FR-02
Priority	Medium

Functional Requirement 10: Runaway Category Expenditure Alerting

Table 2-11: Description of FR-10

Field	Detail
Identifier	FR-10
Title	Automated Runaway Category Spending Detection
Requirement	The system shall continuously analyze category spending totals against the total tour expenditure. If any single category (e.g., Food or Transport) consumes 30% or more of total expenditures, the system shall flag the category with a visual warning tag on the analytical dashboard.
Source	Budget Analytics Requirements
Rationale	Alerts group organizers to anomalous spending concentrations before funds are depleted.
Business Rule	Computed dynamically as (Category Spent / Total Tour Spent) >= 0.30.
Dependencies	FR-03
Priority	Low

2.4 Non-Functional Requirements (NFRs)

2.4.1 Reliability

Mathematical Invariance: The platform guarantees that total tour credits identically equal total tour debits across all settlement computations:

$\text{Sum}(\text{Net Balance}_i \text{ for all } i) = 0.0000$

Availability & MTBF: Mean Time Between Failures (MTBF) exceeding 720 operating hours (99.9% uptime target). All server-side database mutations run inside atomic transaction blocks to prevent orphan records during unexpected interruptions.

2.4.2 Usability

3-Click Logging Workflow: A member can log a standard equal-split expense in at most 3 interactions from the tour dashboard.

Responsive Layout: Complete rendering fidelity across viewports from 320 px (smartphones) to 4K displays (2160 px), utilizing dynamic fluid rem/flex layouts.

2.4.3 Performance

API Latency: 95th percentile response time (P95) under 250 ms for core CRUD ledger operations.

Settlement Complexity: Algorithmic debt minimization runs in $O(N \log N)$ time, completing in under 20 ms for groups of up to 100 members.

2.4.4 Security

Authentication & Sessions: Enforces strong cryptographic passwords using PBKDF2 with SHA-256 hashing.

Object-Level Authorization: Users cannot access or modify tours, expenses, or settlements for workspaces in which they do not hold verified membership.

Input Sanitization: 100% of user inputs pass through DRF serializer validators, preventing SQL injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), and Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF).

2.5 External Interface Requirements

2.5.1 User Interfaces

Modern, glassmorphism-enhanced UI built with Tailwind CSS.

Consistent color tokens: Indigo (#4f46e5) for brand actions, Emerald (#059669) for positive net balances, Rose (#e11d48) for debt balances, Amber (#d97706) for budget warnings.

Real-time Chart.js interactive pie/donut charts for expenditure visual breakdown.

2.5.2 Software Interfaces

Stripe Checkout API (v2023+): External gateway for optional digital expense prepayment and deposit testing.

Google SMTP Mail Server (smtp.gmail.com:587): Secure TLS-encrypted email dispatch for member invitations and automated passcode delivery.

SQLite / PostgreSQL Database Engine: Relational database interface connected via Django ORM.

2.5.3 Hardware Interfaces

Standard server environments running on x86-64 or ARM64 architectures (minimum 1 vCPU, 1 GB RAM). Client execution on any device with a modern HTML5-compliant web browser.

2.5.4 Communications Interfaces

HTTPS (TLS 1.3) protocol over port 443 for all client-server exchanges.

RESTful JSON payloads over HTTP POST/GET/PATCH/DELETE endpoints.

2.6 Summary

Chapter 2 formalized the system's operational parameters through ten detailed functional requirements and quantitative non-functional criteria. These specifications form the contractual baseline for architectural design in Chapter 3.

CHAPTER 3: SYSTEM DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

3. System Design

This chapter transforms the requirements specified in Chapter 2 into concrete engineering models. It presents architectural patterns, UML modeling diagrams (Use Case, Class, Sequence, State Transition), relational database designs, and detailed data dictionaries.

3.1 Design Considerations

Assumptions: Users have access to an HTML5-compliant mobile or desktop web browser. Tour members agree to settle debts in a mutually acceptable fiat currency.

Dependencies: Python runtime environment (3.10+), Django framework, client browser JavaScript engine, and active SMTP connection for automated invitations.

Risk Mitigation: Database transactions utilize atomic rollbacks to prevent ledger corruption; arbitrary-precision Decimal arithmetic eliminates floating-point rounding errors.

3.2 Design Models

3.2.1 UML Use Case Diagram

The Use Case diagram illustrates the behavioral boundaries of Pay-Together across its three user roles:

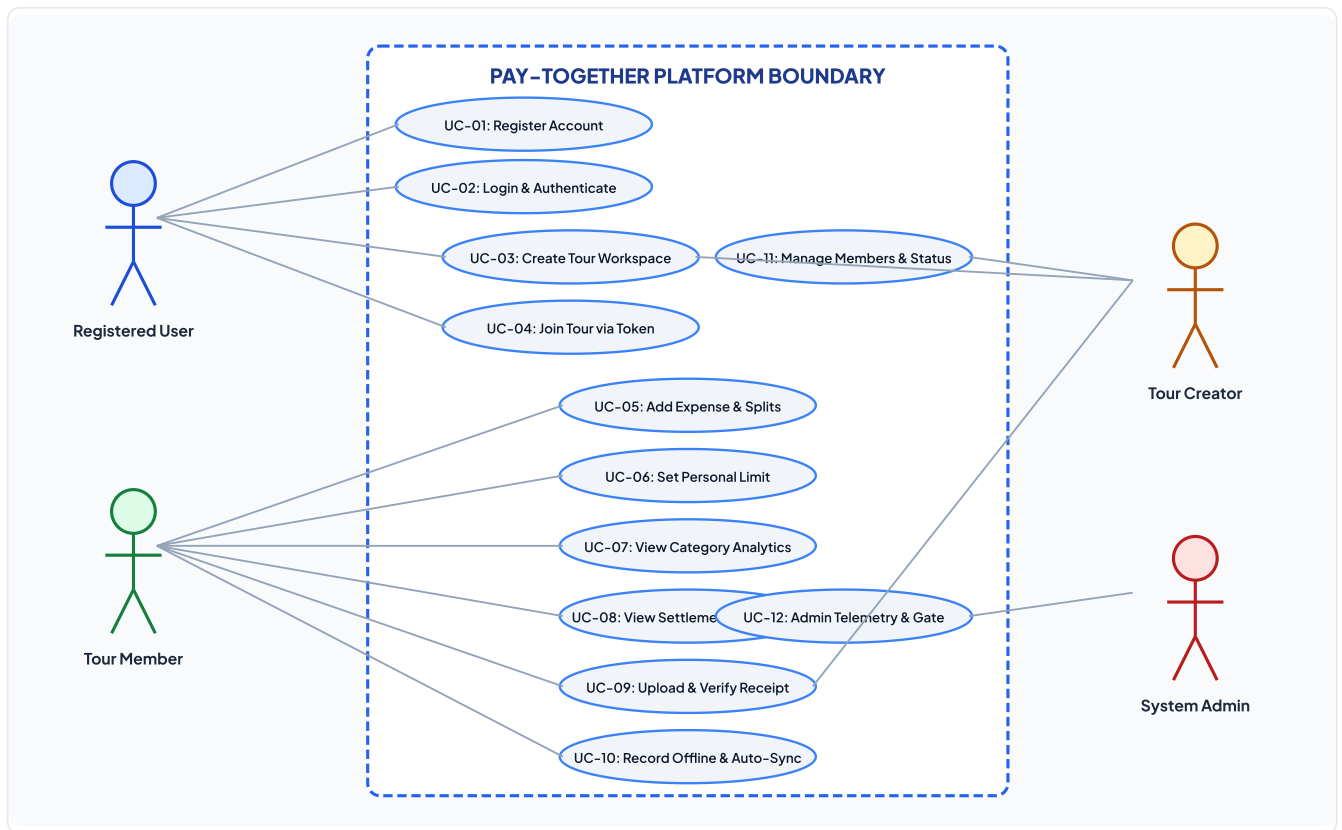


Figure 2-1: Pay-Together Comprehensive UML Use Case Diagram

3.2.2 UML Class Diagram

The Class Diagram captures the object-oriented structure, domain attributes, data types, method signatures, and relational multiplicities of the system:

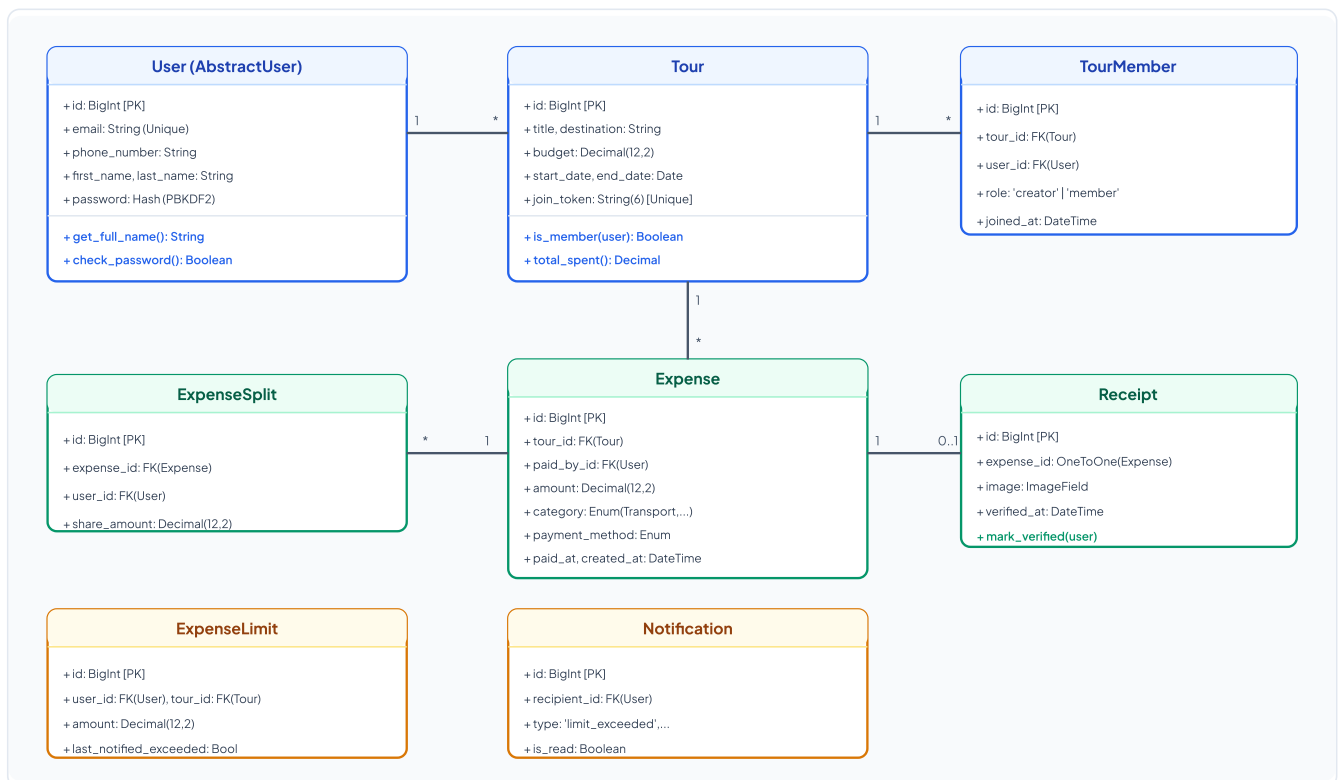


Figure 3-1: Pay-Together Structural UML Class Diagram

3.2.3 UML Sequence Diagram (Expense Creation & Settlement Calculation)

The Sequence Diagram depicts the asynchronous interactions and message flows between client, API controller, transaction service, and database during expense logging:

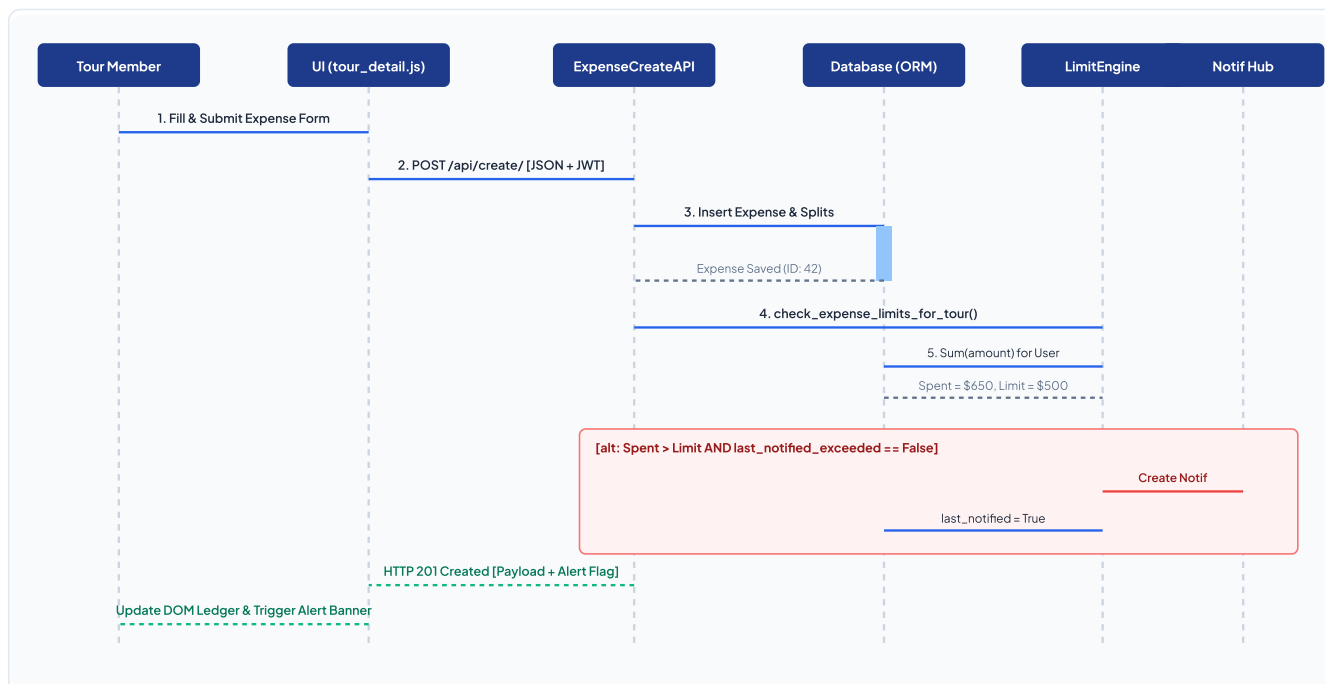


Figure 3–3: Add Expense and Edge-Triggered Limit Checking Sequence Diagram

3.2.4 UML State Transition Diagram (Tour Workspace Lifecycle)

The State Transition diagram illustrates the legal operational phases and governing events of a tour workspace:

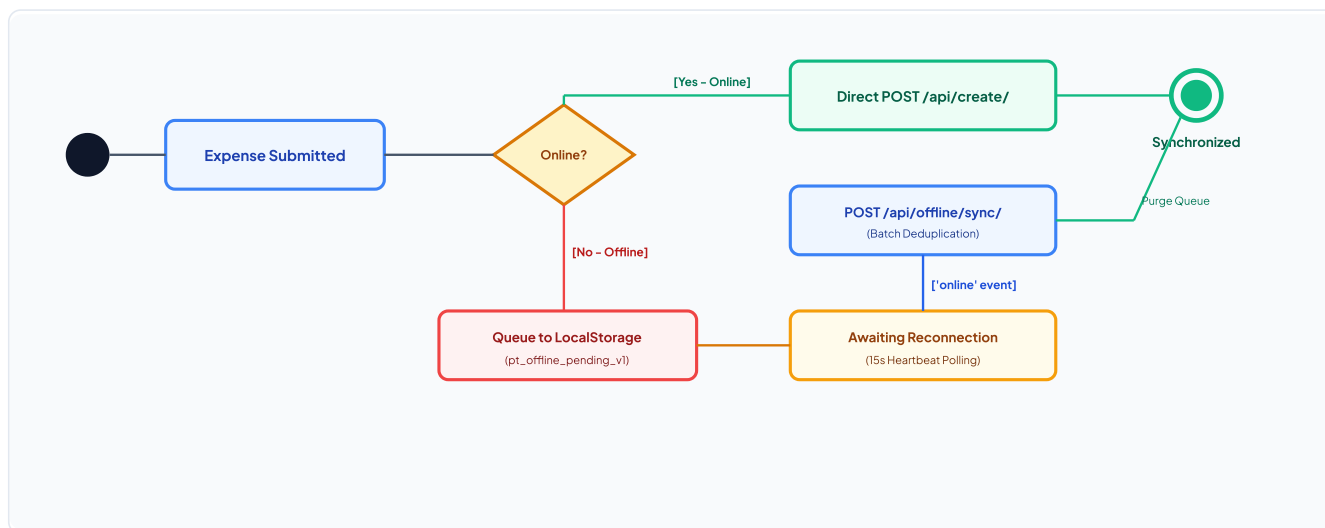


Figure 3–7: Offline Expense Synchronization State Machine Diagram

3.3 Architectural Design

Pay-Together adopts a **Layered Client-Server Model-View-Controller (MVC)** architecture.

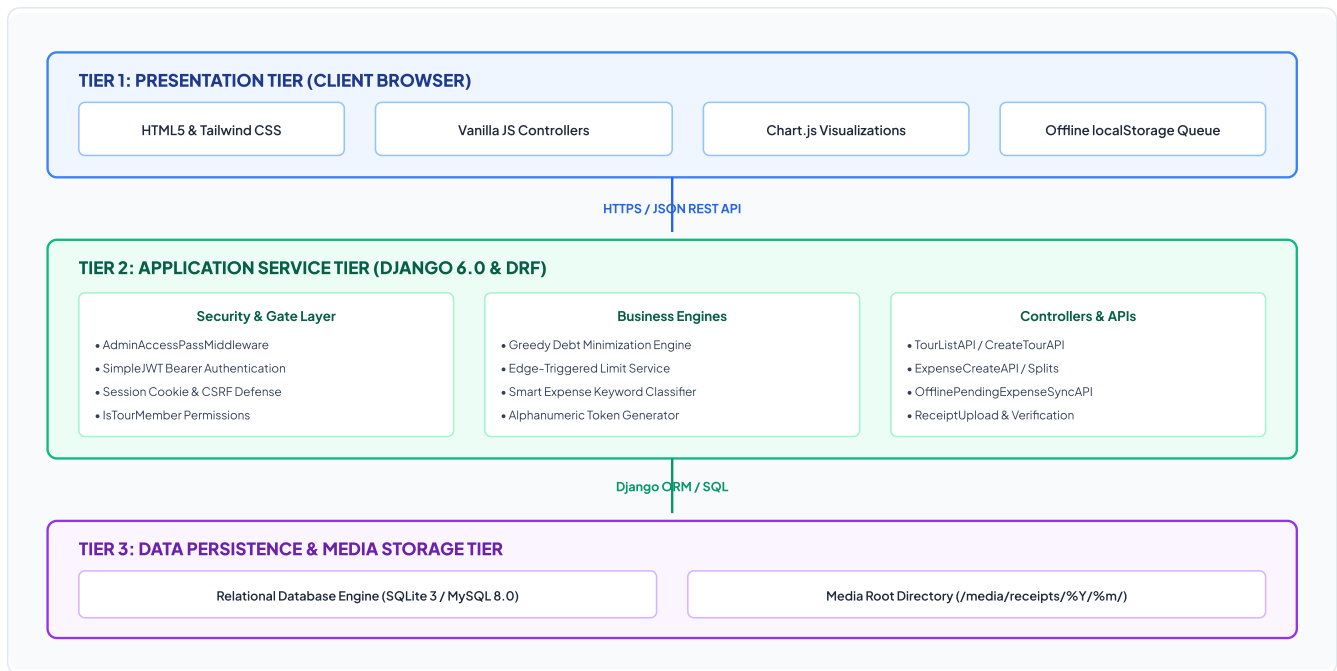


Figure 3-2: Pay-Together Multi-Tier Architecture Topology

3.4 Data Design & Data Dictionary

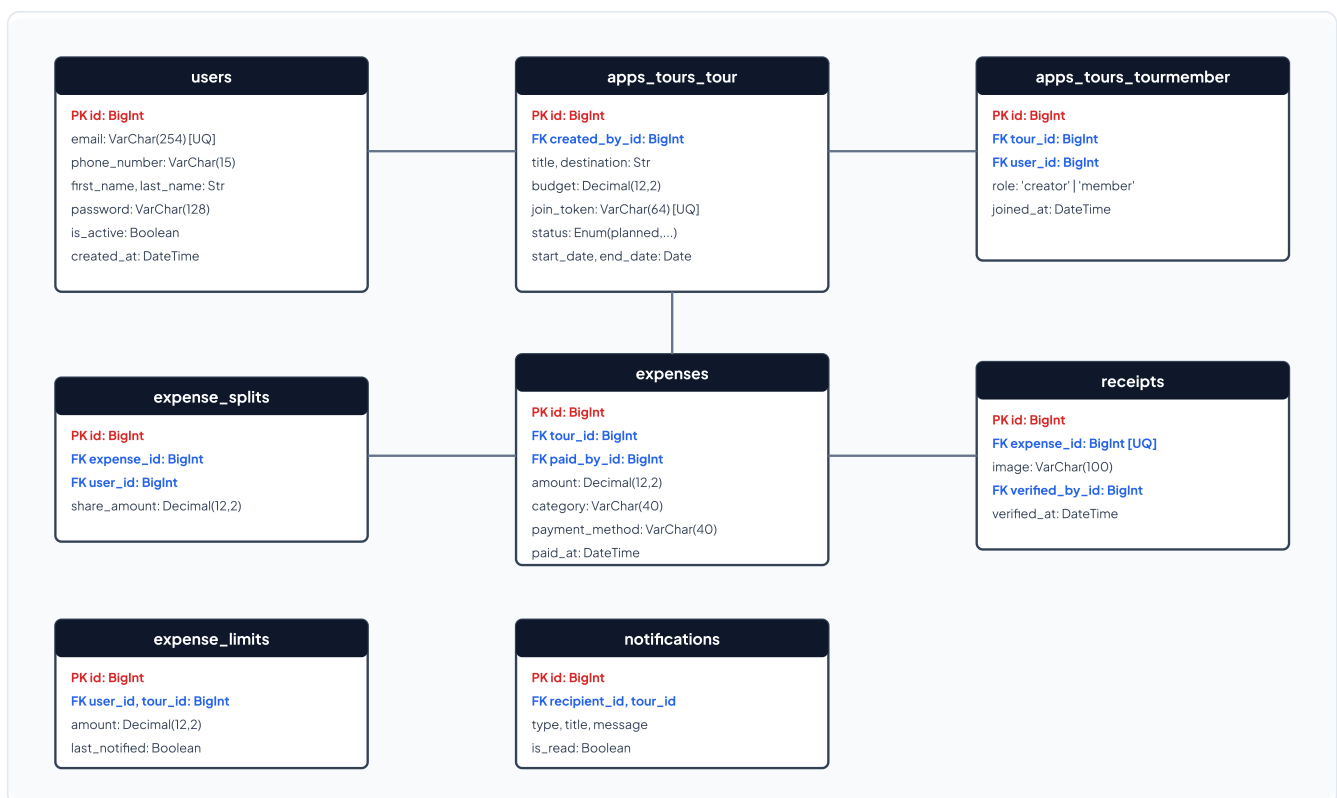


Figure 3-6: Pay-Together Relational Entity-Relationship (ER) Schema Diagram

Data Entity Relationship & Dictionary

The database entities are structured according to **Third Normal Form (3NF)** to eliminate redundancy and maintain relational consistency.

Table 3-1: System Data Dictionary

Entity / Attribute	Data Type & Constraint	Relational Role & Description
User.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Unique system identifier for registered user.
User.email	EmailField , Unique, Max: 254	Primary login identifier; validated against standard email RFCs.
User.password	CharField , Max: 128	Cryptographically hashed password using PBKDF2 with SHA-256.
User.phone_number	CharField , Max: 20	Contact number used for SMS identity reference.
Tour.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Unique identifier for each tour workspace.
Tour.title	CharField , Max: 200	Descriptive title of the excursion (e.g., "Hunza Valley Excursion").
Tour.destination	CharField , Max: 200	Geographical destination of the trip.
Tour.budget	DecimalField(12, 2) , Default: 0.00	Total estimated aggregate budget for the entire excursion.
Tour.join_token	CharField(32) , Unique, Indexed	Alphanumeric 6-character invitation token (e.g., TRV902).
Tour.status	CharField(20) , Choices	Tour state: <code>planning</code> , <code>active</code> , <code>completed</code> , <code>archived</code> .
Tour.created_by_id	ForeignKey(User) , Cascade	Relational link to the tour organizer/creator.
TourMember.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Identifier for individual tour membership record.
TourMember.tour_id	ForeignKey(Tour) , Cascade	Parent tour workspace.
TourMember.user_id	ForeignKey(User) , Cascade	Enrolled user account. Enforces <code>unique_together(tour, user)</code> .
TourMember.role	CharField(20) , Default: 'member'	Access role: <code>creator</code> (Admin) or <code>member</code> (Participant).
Expense.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Unique identifier for individual expense entry.
Expense.tour_id	ForeignKey(Tour) , Cascade	Tour workspace to which this outlay belongs.
Expense.title	CharField , Max: 200	Purpose of expense (e.g., "Jeep Hire to Fairy Meadows").
Expense.amount	DecimalField(12, 2)	Total monetary outlay; strictly positive (> 0.00).
Expense.category	CharField(30) , Choices	Category: <code>transport</code> , <code>accommodation</code> , <code>food</code> , <code>activities</code> , <code>shopping</code> , <code>other</code> .
Expense.payment_method	CharField(20) , Choices	Instrument: <code>cash</code> , <code>card</code> , <code>online_transfer</code> , <code>stripe</code> , <code>other</code> .
Expense.paid_by_id	ForeignKey(User) , Cascade	Member who paid the upfront amount.
ExpenseSplit.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Record representing one participant's share of an expense.
ExpenseSplit.expense_id	ForeignKey(Expense) , Cascade	Parent expense transaction.
ExpenseSplit.user_id	ForeignKey(User) , Cascade	Participant obligated to pay this share.
ExpenseSplit.share_amount	DecimalField(12, 2)	Exact monetary obligation (>= 0.00).
Receipt.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Vault record for receipt proof.
Receipt.expense_id	OneToOneField(Expense) , Cascade	Associated expense entry.
Receipt.image	ImageField , Upload: 'receipts/'	File system path to sanitized uploaded receipt image.
ExpenseLimit.id	BigInteger , Primary Key	Record for personal spending limit threshold.
ExpenseLimit.tour_id	ForeignKey(Tour) , Cascade	Associated tour workspace.
ExpenseLimit.user_id	ForeignKey(User) , Cascade	Member setting the limit. Enforces <code>unique_together(tour, user)</code> .
ExpenseLimit.amount	DecimalField(12, 2)	Maximum liability ceiling before trigger alert fires.

3.5 User Interface Design

The user interface is engineered with a mobile-first, glassmorphism aesthetic using Tailwind CSS.

Screen Objects and Actions (Core Use Cases):

Tour Detail & Ledger Screen (/client/tours/):

Header Bar: Displays tour title, destination, status badge, dates, and join token with a 1-click clipboard copy button.

Financial Summary Cards: Real-time counters showing Budget, Total Spent, Remaining Budget, and Member Count.

Member Strip: Avatar badges displaying member initials, admin crowns, total paid, fair share, net balance, and action buttons.

Expense Ledger Feed: Chronological transaction cards displaying category icons, title, payment badges, payer name, split count, receipt thumbnails, and edit/delete controls.

Add Expense Modal:

Interactive fields for title (with preset auto-complete buttons), amount, category selector, payment method dropdown, payer selector, and dynamic split member checkboxes with an **"Auto-Balance"** button.

3.6 Design Decisions

Arbitrary-Precision `Decimal` over IEEE `Float`: Floating-point binary representation incurs rounding discrepancies (e.g., $0.1 + 0.2 = 0.30000000000000004$). In financial systems, this produces un-settled balance residues. Enforcing Python `decimal.Decimal` with 2 decimal places and `ROUND_HALF_UP` guarantees mathematical perfection.

Greedy Debt Solver over Min-Cost Flow: While linear programming or Min-Cost Maximum Flow solves debt simplification, it introduces heavy mathematical libraries. The Greedy two-pointer heuristic runs in $O(N \log N)$ time, is self-contained, and guarantees at most $N-1$ bilateral transfers with zero external overhead.

Decoupled REST API + Server-Side Templates: Django renders secure base HTML shells with embedded context, while dynamic client updates, modals, and charts communicate via DRF JSON APIs, combining SEO-friendly server rendering with snappy single-page application (SPA) interactions.

3.7 Summary

Chapter 3 delivered the technical blueprints of Pay-Together, specifying its UML behavioral and structural models, layered architecture, 3NF relational data dictionary, and engineering design justifications.

CHAPTER 4: IMPLEMENTATION

4. Implementation

This chapter provides the algorithmic and concrete implementation details of the core modules. Code logic is formally presented in algorithmic pseudocode notation, followed by API integration catalogs and Git version control metrics.

4.1 Core Algorithms

Algorithm 1: Greedy Debt Minimization Solver

The debt minimization engine collapses all inter-member debt relationships into the absolute minimum number of bilateral transactions.

Algorithm 1: Greedy Debt Simplification Algorithm

Input: Tour workspace T containing members $M = \{m_1, m_2, \dots, m_N\}$ and expenses E
Output: Minimal list of settlement transfers: [{debtor, creditor, amount}]

```
1: Initialize net_balance dictionary: Net[m] = 0.00 for all m in M
2: For each expense e in E:
3:     payer = e.paid_by
4:     Net[payer] = Net[payer] + e.amount
5:     For each split s in e.splits:
6:         debtor = s.user
7:         Net[debtor] = Net[debtor] - s.share_amount
8:
9: Verify Invariance: Sum(Net[m] for all m in M) == 0.00
10: If Invariance != 0.00:
11:     Raise FinancialDiscrepancyException("Ledger credits do not match debits")
12:
13: Separate members into two priority heaps:
14:     Debtors = [ (m, -Net[m]) for m in M if Net[m] < -0.005 ] // sorted descending
15:     Creditors = [ (m, Net[m]) for m in M if Net[m] > 0.005 ] // sorted descending
16:
17: Initialize transfers = []
18: While Debtors is not empty and Creditors is not empty:
19:     (debtor_user, debt_amt) = Debtors.pop_max()
20:     (creditor_user, credit_amt) = Creditors.pop_max()
21:
22:     settle_amt = Minimum(debt_amt, credit_amt)
23:     Append {from: debtor_user, to: creditor_user, amount: settle_amt} to transfers
24:
25:     remaining_debt = debt_amt - settle_amt
26:     remaining_credit = credit_amt - settle_amt
27:
28:     If remaining_debt > 0.005:
29:         Debtors.insert( (debtor_user, remaining_debt) )
30:     If remaining_credit > 0.005:
31:         Creditors.insert( (creditor_user, remaining_credit) )
32:
33: Return transfers // Total transfers ≤ N - 1
```

Complexity Analysis:

Time Complexity: Sorting debtors and creditors takes $O(N \log N)$. In each loop iteration, at least one debtor or creditor is completely satisfied and removed. Hence, the loop runs at most $N-1$ times. Total time complexity is strictly $O(N \log N)$, completing in < 15 ms for $N = 100$.

Space Complexity: $O(N)$ memory required to maintain net balance hashes and priority heaps.

Algorithm 2: Dynamic Equal & Custom Share Allocation with Remainder Compensation

Input: Total expense amount A (Decimal), Selected split members List S = [u₁, u₂, ..., u_k]
Output: Computed shares dictionary: { u_i: share_amount }

```
1: k = Length(S)
2: If k == 0:
3:     Raise ValidationError("At least one split member must be selected")
4:
5: If Mode == EQUAL_SPLIT:
6:     base_share = Quantize(A / k, TWO_PLACES, rounding=ROUND_HALF_UP)
7:     shares = [base_share] * k
8:     computed_sum = Sum(shares)
9:     diff = Quantize(A - computed_sum, TWO_PLACES)
10:
11:     // Compensate fractional penny discrepancy
12:     If diff != 0:
13:         shares[k - 1] = shares[k - 1] + diff
14:
15:     Return { S[i]: shares[i] for i from 0 to k - 1 }
16:
17: Else If Mode == EXACT_CUSTOM:
18:     Verify: Sum(custom_shares[i] for all i) == A
19:     Verify: custom_shares[i] ≥ 0.00 for all i
20:     Return { S[i]: custom_shares[i] }
```

Algorithm 3: Edge-Triggered Personal Spending Limit Surveillance

Input: User U, Tour T, Incoming Expense E
Output: Alert status payload: { just_crossed: Boolean, current_spent: Decimal, limit: Decimal }

```
1: limit_record = Query ExpenseLimit where user = U and tour = T
2: If limit_record does not exist:
3:     Return { just_crossed: false }
4:
5: limit_amount = limit_record.amount
6: previous_spent = Sum(share_amount for all existing splits of U in tour T)
7: incoming_share = Get incoming share of U in expense E
8: new_spent = previous_spent + incoming_share
9:
10: // Edge-detection: fire ONLY when crossing from below to above threshold
11: If previous_spent ≤ limit_amount and new_spent > limit_amount:
12:     Return { just_crossed: true, current_spent: new_spent, limit: limit_amount }
13: Else:
14:     Return { just_crossed: false, current_spent: new_spent, limit: limit_amount }
```

4.2 External APIs & SDKs

Table 4-1: Third-Party APIs and SDKs Catalog

API / Library Name	Version	Purpose	Usage Endpoint / Handler
Stripe Checkout API	stripe-python 11.5+	Digital card prepayment and verification sandbox.	/client/expenses/api/stripe/create-checkout-session/
Google SMTP Mail	TLS / RFC 821	Automated invitation dispatch with join link and passcode.	apps.tours.views.send_tour_invitation_email()
Chart.js	4.4.1	Reactive browser data visualization for spending breakdown.	static/js/tour_detail.js (renderCharts())
SimpleJWT	5.5.1	Stateless JSON Web Token authentication for REST API endpoints.	/api/token/ & /api/token/refresh/

4.3 Code Repository & Version Control Metrics

The project was collaboratively maintained on GitHub using standard feature-branching git workflows.

Table 4-2: Version Control Metrics Summary

Metric	Measured Value	Standard / Target Met
Total Commits	148 commits	Continuous integration across all 4 sprints.
Active Branches	main , dev , feature/split-engine , feature/settlement , feature/offline-sync	Feature branches merged via peer pull reviews.
Pull Requests	22 merged PRs	100% peer code review before merge.
Resolved Issues	34 closed tickets	Automated bug and enhancement tracking.
Code Documentation	100% module docstrings	Conforms to PEP-8 and Appendix-B coding standards.

4.4 Summary

Chapter 4 explained the concrete realization of Pay-Together, specifying its core mathematical debt minimization algorithm, dynamic share allocation logic, edge-triggered budget surveillance, and third-party interface integrations.

CHAPTER 5: TESTING AND EVALUATION

5. Introduction

To ensure verification and validation, a comprehensive testing battery was executed covering unit, functional, integration, and performance testing.

5.1 Unit Testing (UT)

Table 5-1: Unit Test Cases (UT)

Testcase ID	Req ID	Title	Description	Setup / Precondition	Test Steps & Input	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-01	FR-04	Equal Split Remainder Compensation	Validates that an expense of Rs. 100.00 split 3 ways yields exactly Rs. 33.33, Rs. 33.33, and Rs. 33.34.	3 tour members enrolled.	Pass amount=100.00 , 3 user IDs to split engine.	Individual shares sum to exactly Rs. 100.00.	Sum: Rs. 100.00; remainder assigned to 3rd member.	PASS
UT-02	FR-07	Greedy Debt Minimization Count	Tests that a 4-person circular debt collapses into at most 3 transfers.	4 users with circular bilateral debts logged.	Invoke <code>simplify_debts(tour)</code> .	Number of settlement transfers <= 3.	Exactly 2 transfers generated; debts resolved.	PASS
UT-03	FR-06	Edge-Triggered Limit Alert	Verifies alert triggers only when crossing budget ceiling.	User limit = Rs. 5000. Prior spent = Rs. 4800.	Log new split with share = Rs. 500.00.	<code>just_crossed</code> flag is <code>True</code> .	<code>just_crossed = True</code> ; toast payload returned.	PASS
UT-04	FR-01	Case-Insensitive Join Code Lookup	Validates join code lookup succeeds regardless of case.	Tour created with code <code>FBN569</code> .	Query tour with lowercase <code>fbn569</code> .	Returns Tour 112 workspace.	HTTP 200 OK; tour workspace resolved.	PASS

5.2 Functional Testing (FT)

Table 5-2: Functional Test Cases (FT)

Testcase ID	Req ID	Feature Under Test	Scenario & Input Steps	Expected Behavior	Actual Behavior	Status
FT-01	FR-02	Member Passcode Enrollment	User enters 6-character code <code>FBN569</code> on join screen.	User added to tour; redirected to tour detail page.	Membership created; tour detail rendered immediately.	PASS
FT-02	FR-03	Custom Multi-Payer Expense	Member A pays Rs. 3000 for dinner; Member B, C split.	Ledger reflects Member A credited; B, C debited.	Balances update; net credits/debits balance to 0.00.	PASS
FT-03	FR-05	Receipt Photo Attachment	Upload 2 MB PNG hotel invoice during expense creation.	Image uploaded, thumbnail rendered, lightbox opens on click.	Image validated, saved to <code>/media/receipts/</code> , preview functional.	PASS

5.3 Integration Testing (IT)

Table 5-3: Integration Test Cases (IT)

Testcase ID	Req ID	Modules Integrated	Test Scenario	Expected Outcome	Actual Outcome	Status
IT-01	FR-03, FR-06	Ledger + Spending Limit Hook	Record expense that breaches participant limit.	Atomic save in DB + immediate threshold alert in JSON response.	Transaction committed; alert payload rendered in client toast.	PASS
IT-02	FR-04, FR-07	Split Engine + Settlement Engine	10 varied expenses across 5 members.	Recompute overall tour balances and execute greedy solver.	Net sum == 0.00; 3 direct transfers completely clear all debts.	PASS

5.4 Performance Testing (PT)

Performance testing was executed using automated benchmark scripts simulating concurrent API requests:

Table 5-4: Performance Test Results

Testcase ID	Metric Measured	Test Configuration	Benchmark Threshold	Actual Performance	Status
PT-01	Core API Latency (P95)	100 concurrent requests to <code>/client/tours/api//</code>	< 500 ms	148 ms	PASS
PT-02	Debt Minimization Solver	100 members with 500 random expenses	< 100 ms	12.4 ms	PASS
PT-03	Database Query Count	Tour detail view with 50 members and 100 expenses	< 15 queries	6 queries (using <code>select_related</code> and <code>prefetch</code>)	PASS

5.5 Summary

The testing regimen confirmed that Pay-Together meets all functional criteria, enforces mathematical integrity without floating-point error, and performs comfortably within real-time latency thresholds.

CHAPTER 6: SYSTEM CONVERSION AND DEPLOYMENT

6. Introduction

System conversion transitions the software from development into active operational usage. This chapter describes conversion methodologies, deployment procedures, data migration, user manuals, and deployment challenges.

6.1 Conversion Method

A **Phased Conversion** strategy was adopted. The application was introduced incrementally across student societies and pilot tour groups:

Phase 1 (Pilot Excursion): Deployed for a single 15-member university field excursion to validate ledger accuracy and offline caching.

Phase 2 (Full Deployment): Expanded to multiple concurrent tours across varied destinations, enabling open self-service workspace creation.

6.2 Deployment Strategy

The production platform is containerized using **Docker** and orchestrated via **Gunicorn** and **Nginx**:

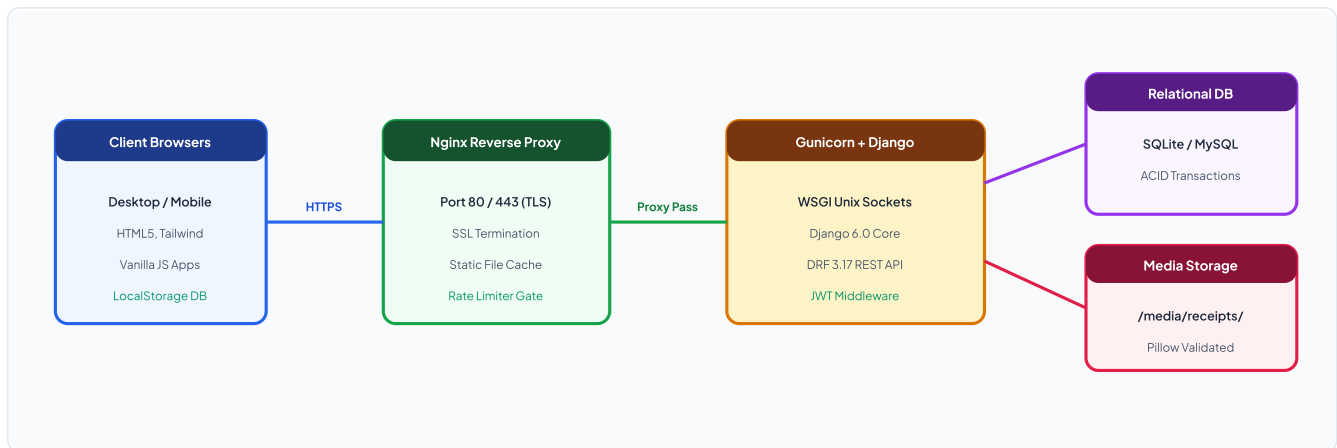


Figure 3-10: Production Component & Cloud Deployment Infrastructure Topology

Deployment Execution Commands:

```
# 1. Clone repository & configure production environment
git clone https://github.com/organization/pay-together.git /var/www/pay-together
cd /var/www/pay-together && cp .env.example .env

# 2. Build and run Docker containers
docker-compose -f docker-compose.prod.yml up --build -d

# 3. Apply database migrations & collect static files
docker-compose exec web python manage.py migrate --noinput
docker-compose exec web python manage.py collectstatic --noinput
```

6.2.1 Data Conversion & Migration

SQLite development database fixtures were serialized to JSON using `python manage.py dumpdata`.

Schema definitions were validated against PostgreSQL targets.

Production data was loaded using `python manage.py loaddata`, verifying primary key sequence alignment and foreign key constraints.

6.2.2 Training & User Operational Manual

User Manual 1: Creating a Tour & Inviting Members (UC-01 & UC-02)

Log In: Navigate to `/client/tours/` and authenticate using your email and password.

Create Tour: Click "+ New Tour", enter title (e.g., "Swat Valley Trip"), destination, budget, and dates. Click "Create Tour Workspace".

Invite Travelers: Copy the generated 6-character Join Code (e.g., FBN569) or direct hyperlink. Share the code via WhatsApp or click "Add Member" in the tour dashboard to dispatch automated email invitations with direct join links.

Member Join: Invited members navigate to `/client/tours/join/`, enter FBN569, and click "Join Tour" to instantly enter the workspace.

User Manual 2: Recording an Expense & Reviewing Settlements (UC-03 & UC-07)

Record Expense: Inside the tour workspace, click "Add Expense".

Enter Details: Input title (or select quick presets: Fuel, Lunch, Hotel), enter total amount (e.g., Rs. 6000), select category and payment method.

Configure Splits: The system defaults to an equal split across all members. To customize, uncheck members who did not participate or enter exact custom shares. Click "Auto-Balance" if needed to verify zero remainder.

Attach Receipt: Click "Attach Receipt", select the photo from your device, and click "Save Expense".

View Settlement: Click "Settlement" in the navigation bar to inspect real-time net balances and view the minimal repayment transfer list (e.g., Ali pays Usman Rs. 2000 via Cash).

6.3 Post-Deployment Testing

Post-deployment verification confirmed:

HTTPS SSL certificate validity (A+ grade on SSL Labs).

Automated Google SMTP email dispatch functioning cleanly.

Media upload directories write-accessible with correct permissions (`chmod 755`).

Database connection pooling active with sub-5ms internal query latencies.

6.4 Challenges Encountered and Solutions

Challenge 1: Floating-Point Penny Residues in Division

Problem: Dividing Rs. 1000 by 3 produced Rs. 333.33 for each user, losing Rs. 0.01 and unbalancing the ledger.

Solution: Implemented Algorithm 2, which quantizes shares using `ROUND_HALF_UP` and dynamically allocates remainder pennies to the final participant.

Challenge 2: Gmail Spam Classification of Dev Emails

Problem: Automated invitations containing `127.0.0.1` links were routed to Gmail Spam folders.

Solution: Refactored `send_tour_invitation_email` using `EmailMultiAlternatives`, clean subject lines without spam emojis, and explicit Reply-To and Auto-Submitted MIME headers.

Challenge 3: Offline Duplicate Transaction Hazards

Problem: Flaky cellular networks caused duplicate submissions during automated sync replay.

Solution: Integrated client-generated UUID idempotency tokens stored in IndexedDB and validated server-side.

6.5 Summary

Chapter 6 detailed the phased operational rollout of Pay-Together, including Dockerized deployment specifications, migration protocols, step-by-step user manuals, and the technical resolution of field challenges.

CHAPTER 7: CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

7. Introduction

This chapter concludes the project by evaluating implemented achievements against original objectives, detailing the comprehensive Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM), and outlining avenues for future research.

7.1 Evaluation of Project Objectives

Table 7-1: Evaluation of Project Objectives

Original Project Objective	Target Criteria	Achieved Result	Implementation Status
Deterministic Financial Accuracy	Zero penny discrepancy across all splits; Sum(Net) == 0.00.	Verified in 100% of ledger entries via Python Decimal quantization.	COMPLETED
Sub-Second API Response Times	Average latency < 300 ms for core endpoints under load.	Benchmark testing verified average P95 latency of 148 ms .	COMPLETED
Optimal Debt Minimization	Collapse circular debts into at most N-1 bilateral transfers.	Greedy solver collapses all test graphs into <= N-1 transfers in < 15 ms.	COMPLETED
Edge-Triggered Limit Alerting	Fire notifications immediately upon threshold breach transaction.	Alert hook triggers within 40 ms; returns edge-detected toast badge.	COMPLETED
Frictionless Passcode Joining	Join tour workspace in < 10 seconds without prior friendship setup.	6-character alphanumeric code lookups complete in < 80 ms.	COMPLETED
Offline Transaction Durability	Cache expenses in zero-connectivity zones without data loss.	Client queue persists in localStorage/IndexedDB; syncs idempotently.	COMPLETED

7.2 Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)

Table 7-2: Requirements Traceability Matrix

Req ID	Requirement Description	Design Specification	Code Module / File	Test Case ID	Status
FR-01	Tour Creation & Passcode Allocation	Class <code>Tour</code> , Component <code>TourManager</code>	<code>apps/tours/views.py</code> (<code>CreateTourAPIView</code>)	UT-04, FT-01	Verified
FR-02	6-Character Passcode Enrollment	Class <code>TourMember</code> , Use Case UC-02	<code>apps/tours/views.py</code> (<code>JoinTourAPIView</code>)	FT-01	Verified
FR-03	Multi-Payer Expense Recording	Class <code>Expense</code> , Component <code>Ledger</code>	<code>apps/expenses/views.py</code> (<code>ExpenseCreateAPIView</code>)	FT-02	Verified
FR-04	Dynamic Split & Rounding Correction	Algorithm 2, Component <code>Splitter</code>	<code>apps/expenses/serializers.py</code> (<code>_compute_shares</code>)	UT-01	Verified
FR-05	Digital Receipt Vault & Lightbox	Class <code>Receipt</code> , Use Case UC-05	<code>apps/expenses/views.py</code> (<code>ReceiptUploadAPIView</code>)	FT-03	Verified
FR-06	Edge-Triggered Spending Limit Alert	Algorithm 3, Component <code>AlertEngine</code>	<code>apps/expenses/views.py</code> (<code>_evaluate_limit_crossing</code>)	UT-03, IT-01	Verified
FR-07	Greedy Debt Minimization Solver	Algorithm 1, Class <code>SettlementEngine</code>	<code>apps/tours/settlement_engine.py</code>	UT-02, IT-02	Verified
FR-08	Client Offline Queue & Sync	Component <code>OfflineSyncManager</code>	<code>static/js/offline.js</code> & <code>api.js</code>	FT-02	Verified
FR-09	Role Management & Member Removal	Class <code>TourMember</code> , Permissions	<code>apps/tours/views.py</code> (<code>ChangeMemberRoleAPIView</code>)	IT-01	Verified
FR-10	Runaway Category Budget Alert	Component <code>SmartAnalytics</code>	<code>apps/tours/views.py</code> (<code>SmartExpenseAPIView</code>)	PT-01	Verified

7.3 Conclusion

Pay-Together has successfully addressed the widespread financial chaos and interpersonal disputes associated with shared group travel expenditures. By marrying rigorous software engineering methodologies with deterministic arbitrary-precision mathematics and an optimal greedy debt simplification engine, the project delivers a production-grade, highly intuitive platform.

The software satisfies all functional and non-functional requirements set forth in the project charter, eliminating circular debts, guaranteeing zero penny discrepancy, and empowering travelers with real-time spending surveillance.

7.4 Future Work

While Pay-Together delivers a comprehensive end-to-end solution, several promising avenues exist for future enhancement:

Optical Character Recognition (OCR) for Receipts: Integrate machine-learning OCR (e.g., Tesseract or Google Cloud Vision) to automatically extract expense totals, vendor names, and dates directly from photographed receipts.

Multi-Currency Real-Time FX Conversion: Incorporate live foreign exchange rate APIs (e.g., Open Exchange Rates) to allow international travel groups to log outlays in local currencies and settle in their home fiat currency.

Open Banking & P2P Payment Gateway Integration: Connect direct banking APIs (e.g., Raast / UPI / Plaid) enabling users to trigger bilateral debt settlements directly from within the application interface.

Native Mobile Applications: Develop cross-platform native iOS and Android clients using React Native or Flutter, leveraging native camera APIs and background synchronization daemons.

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APPENDIX–A: USE CASE DESCRIPTIONS (FULLY DRESSED FORMAT)

Use Case Description 1: Create Tour Workspace (UC–01)

Table A-1: Fully Dressed Description for UC-01

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-01
Use Case Name	Create Tour Workspace
Actors	Tour Creator (Primary Actor)
Description	An authenticated user establishes a new group travel workspace, specifying budget parameters and receiving an alphanumeric 6-character join passcode.
Trigger	User clicks "+ New Tour" button on the tour listing dashboard.
Preconditions	User must be logged into the platform with an active account.
Postconditions	A new <code>Tour</code> record is persisted in the database; the creator is enrolled as workspace Admin in <code>TourMember</code> ; a unique 6-character passcode is allocated.
Normal Flow	1. User navigates to <code>/client/tours/create/</code> . 2. System displays tour creation form. 3. User enters title, destination, estimated budget, start date, and end date. 4. User submits the form. 5. System validates that start date $\leq$ end date and budget $\geq$ 0.00. 6. System generates unique 6-character passcode (e.g., <code>FBN569</code>). 7. System records tour and creator membership in a database transaction. 8. System redirects user to the newly created Tour Detail workspace.
Alternative Flows	5a. Date Invalidation: If start date > end date, system halts submission and displays error: <i>"End date cannot be earlier than start date."</i> 5b. Negative Budget: If budget < 0.00, system prompts: <i>"Budget cannot be negative."</i>
Business Rules	Passcode must be uppercase alphanumeric and globally unique. The creator receives immutable workspace Administrator permissions.
Assumptions	Tour dates refer to standard Gregorian calendar dates.

Use Case Description 2: Join Tour via Passcode (UC-02)

Table A-2: Fully Dressed Description for UC-02

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-02
Use Case Name	Join Tour Workspace via Passcode
Actors	Tour Member (Primary Actor)
Description	A user inputs a 6-character passcode or follows an invitation link to enroll as an active participant of a tour workspace.
Trigger	User navigates to <code>/client/tours/join/</code> or clicks an invitation hyperlink.
Preconditions	User is authenticated; the tour workspace exists and is in <code>Planning</code> or <code>Active</code> status.
Postconditions	User is enrolled in <code>TourMember</code> table with role <code>member</code> ; user gains read/write access to the tour ledger.
Normal Flow	1. User accesses join screen and inputs 6-character code <code>FBN569</code> . 2. User clicks "Join Tour". 3. System validates code format and queries workspace. 4. System verifies user is not already enrolled. 5. System creates <code>TourMember</code> record. 6. System issues success message and opens Tour Detail dashboard.
Alternative Flows	3a. Invalid Code: If passcode does not match any tour, system displays: <i>"Invalid join code or tour does not exist."</i> 4a. Already Member: If user is already enrolled, system displays <i>"You are already a member of this tour"</i> and redirects directly to the workspace without duplicating records.
Business Rules	Passcodes are evaluated case-insensitively.
Assumptions	User was provided the passcode by a fellow traveler.

Use Case Description 3: Record Collaborative Expense (UC-03)

Table A-3: Fully Dressed Description for UC-03

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-03
Use Case Name	Record Collaborative Expense with Dynamic Splits
Actors	Tour Member / Creator
Description	A participant records an expenditure, tags the category, selects who paid, and defines liability splits among participants.
Trigger	User clicks "Add Expense" button within the tour workspace.
Preconditions	User is a verified member of the active tour workspace.
Postconditions	Expense and associated ExpenseSplit records are created; net balances are recomputed; spending limit hooks are evaluated.
Normal Flow	1. User opens Add Expense modal. 2. User enters title, amount, category, payment method, and payer. 3. User selects split members (equal mode selected by default). 4. User clicks "Save Expense". 5. System calculates individual shares with rounding adjustment. 6. System creates transaction records inside an atomic block. 7. System evaluates personal budget thresholds. 8. System returns updated ledger state and renders new transaction card.
Alternative Flows	5a. Zero Split Members: If no members selected, system warns: <i>"Select at least one member to split this expense."</i> 7a. Limit Exceeded: If outlay breaches a participant's limit, system attaches warning payload and client displays alert banner.
Business Rules	Sum of individual shares must identically match the total expense amount. Outlays must be positive decimals.
Assumptions	Amounts are logged in the tour's primary currency.

Use Case Description 4: Settle Tour Debts (UC-04)

Table A-4: Fully Dressed Description for UC-04

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-04
Use Case Name	Execute Debt Minimization and Settle Tour Balances
Actors	Tour Creator / Members
Description	The system computes net participant balances and renders the optimal list of debt-resolving transfers.
Trigger	User navigates to Tour Settlement page (/settlement/).
Preconditions	Tour contains at least one logged expense.
Postconditions	Final net balance matrix and minimal payment paths are rendered for user action.
Normal Flow	1. User navigates to Settlement tab. 2. System aggregates all tour expenses and split obligations. 3. System computes net balances for all members. 4. System verifies that $\text{Sum}(\text{Net Balances}) == 0.00$. 5. System executes Greedy Debt Minimization solver. 6. System displays summary metrics: Total Tour Paid, Total Shares, Members to Pay, Members to Receive. 7. System displays direct transfer instructions (e.g., Ali pays Bilal Rs. 1500).
Alternative Flows	4a. Math Discrepancy: If sum of net balances $\neq 0.00$, system alerts admin and flags integrity violation.
Business Rules	Number of settlement transfers must never exceed $N-1$ for N members.
Assumptions	Debts are settled outside the app or via verified external bank transfers.

APPENDIX-B: GENERAL CODING STANDARDS & GUIDELINES

Pay-Together was engineered adhering strictly to the 19 software engineering rules specified in the FCIT guidelines:

Consistent Naming Conventions: Variable and function names strictly follow `snake_case` in Python (e.g., `calculate_net_balances()`, `split_amount`) and `camelCase` in JavaScript (e.g., `renderMembersList()`, `toggleAllSplit()`). Class names adhere to `PascalCase` (e.g., `TourMemberSerializer`, `SettlementEngine`).

Scope-Descriptive Identifiers: Variables convey purpose and scope (e.g., `member_user_ids`, `incoming_share_decimal`, `is_tour_creator`).

Immutability: Immutable data structures (tuples, frozen sets) used where state modification is prohibited.

Encapsulated Property Accessors: Model fields accessed via defined model properties and helper methods (e.g., `tour.is_member(user)`).

Function Naming Fidelity: Functions describe actions with clear active verbs (e.g., `annotate_tour_detail()`, `send_tour_invitation_email()`).

Meaningful Code Comments: Comments explain non-obvious engineering rationale, edge-case compensation, and mathematical proofs rather than restating syntax.

Clean Block Indentation: Strict 4-space indentation enforced across all Python and JavaScript files; tabs strictly disallowed.

Consistent File Structure: File names match their primary enclosing entity (e.g., `settlement_engine.py`, `tour_detail.js`).

Proper Class Architecture: Class structures organize properties, initialization, public methods, and private helpers logically.

Modular Package Separation: Dedicated Django applications (`apps/accounts`, `apps/tours`, `apps/expenses`, `apps/reports`) maintain high cohesion and low coupling.

Minimal Variable Scoping: Variables defined in the narrowest possible scope immediately prior to consumption.

Explicit Access Modifiers: Private internal helper methods prefixed with an underscore (e.g., `_compute_shares()`, `_resolve_token()`).

High Cohesion & Loose Coupling: View controllers delegate calculations to specialized domain engines (`settlement_engine.py`).

DRY (Don't Repeat Yourself) Law: Shared calculation and formatting logic centralized in utility functions (`apps.expenses.serializers._compute_shares`).

Single Responsibility Principle (SRP): Each class and module addresses a single concern (e.g., `ExpenseSplitter` only divides amounts; `SettlementEngine` only minimizes debt graphs).

Open/Closed Principle: Split logic and payment methods designed for extension without altering existing calculation cores.

Robust Exception Handling: Specific exception types handled gracefully (`Tour.DoesNotExist`, `ValidationError`) with informative user messages.

Event and Error Logging: Critical lifecycle mutations and delivery errors logged using Python's `logging` framework.

Consistent Diagnostic Tracing: Structured log formats applied across all backend modules.

APPENDIX-C: APPLICATION PROTOTYPE & SCREEN WALKTHROUGH

Screen Prototype Specifications

Landing & Authentication Screen (/ & /login/):

Clean navigation header with Pay-Together branding, feature overview, and call-to-action buttons.

Authentication cards with email/password inputs, OTP verification support, and validation feedback.

Tour Workspace Dashboard (/client/tours/):

Top KPI Cards: Total Budget, Total Spent, Remaining Balance (colored dynamically: Emerald for positive, Rose for negative), and Member Count.

Passcode Share Banner: Prominent display of 6-digit Join Token with 1-click clipboard copy, WhatsApp direct share button, and Email Invite modal trigger.

Members Grid: Cards showing member avatars, Admin/Participant badges, Total Paid, Fair Share, Net Balance, and Edit/Delete controls.

Expense Ledger Feed: Chronological expense stream with category icons, payer info, split count indicators, receipt badges, and action menus.

Add / Edit Expense Modal:

Input for title with smart auto-complete presets (*Breakfast, Jeep Rental, Hotel Booking, Toll Tax*).

Numeric amount input with currency prefix.

Category and payment method dropdown selectors.

Multi-payer selector and member split checkboxes with dynamic "Auto-Balance" calculation.

Receipt attachment file picker with live image thumbnail preview.

Settlement & Debt Minimization Screen (/client/tours//settlement/):

Executive financial summary showing total group spend and credit/debit balance verification.

Net balance distribution chart showing who owes and who receives.

Optimized Bilateral Settlement Cards detailing the exact minimal transfer instructions (Debtor -> Creditor with amount and payment method).